Learn the Signs. Act Early.

Milestones by 15 Months

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For Everyone

MAY 15, 2026 • ESPAÑOL

WHAT TO KNOW

- Learn about the developmental milestones that most children do by 15 months of age.
- See important information to share with your doctor.
- Find tips and activities you can do for your 15-month-old.



Ways to monitor milestones

How your child plays, learns, speaks, acts, and moves offers important clues about your child's development. Developmental miles things most children (75% or more) can do by a certain age.

Milestone checklists

Check the milestones your child has reached by 15 months by completing a checklist, available below and in three additional form

- CDC's free *Milestone Tracker* mobile app, for iOS and Android devices
- Web-based Digital Online Checklist
- Printable checklist PDF

Keep in mind

Learn the Signs. Act Early. materials are not a substitute for standardized, validated developmental screening tools.

What most children do by 15 months

Click the links below to view a photo or video of each milestone.

Social/Emotional Milestones

- Copies other children while playing, like taking toys out of a container when another child does
- Shows you an object she likes
- Claps when excited
- Hugs stuffed doll or other toy
- Shows you affection (hugs, cuddles, or kisses you)

Language/Communication Milestones

- Tries to say one or two words besides “mama” or “dada,” like “ba” for ball or “da” for dog
- Looks at a familiar object when you name it
- Follows directions given with both a gesture and words. For example, he gives you a toy when you hold out your hand and say, toy.”
- Points to ask for something or to get help

Cognitive Milestones (learning, thinking, problem-solving)

- Tries to use things the right way, like a phone, cup, or book
- Stacks at least two small objects, like blocks

Movement/Physical Development Milestones

- Takes a few steps on his own
- Uses fingers to feed herself some food

SEE ALSO
More about physical development

Share with your child’s doctor

Things to share and consider

- What are some things you and your child do together?
- What are some things your child likes to do?
- Is there anything your child does or does not do that concerns you?
- Has your child lost any skills he/she once had?
- Does your child have any special healthcare needs or was he/she born prematurely?

You know your child best. Don't wait. If your child is not meeting one or more milestones, has lost skills he or she once had, or you concerns, act early. Talk with your child's doctor, share your concerns, and ask about developmental screening.

If you or the doctor are still concerned

- Ask for a referral to a specialist who can evaluate your child more; and
- Call your state or territory's early intervention program to find out if your child can get services to help. Learn more and find t at cdc.gov/FindEI.

KEEP READING
Concerned About Your Child's Development?

Tips and activities

What You Can Do for Your 15-month-old



As your child's first teacher, you can help his or her development.

As your child's first teacher, you can help his or her learning and brain development. Try these simple tips and activities in a safe w your child's doctor and teachers if you have questions or for more ideas on how to help your child's development.

- Help your child learn to speak. A child's early words are not complete. Repeat and add to what he says. He may say "ba" for ball say "Ball, yes, that's a ball."
- Tell your child the names of objects when he points to them and wait a few seconds to see if he makes any sounds before handi he does make a sound, acknowledge him, and repeat the name of the object. "Yes! Cup."
- Find ways to let your child help with everyday activities. Let her get her shoes to go outside, put the snacks in the bag for the pa

socks in the basket.

More Parenting Tips and Activities

- Have steady routines for sleeping and feeding. Create a calm, quiet bedtime for your child. Put on his pajamas, brush his teet 1 or 2 books to him. Children between 1 and 2 years of age need 11 to 14 hours of sleep a day (including naps). Consistent s make it easier!
- Show your child different things, such as a hat. Ask him, "What do you do with a hat? You put it on your head." Put it on your then give it to him to see if he copies you. Do this with other objects, such as a book or a cup.
- Sing songs with gestures, such as "Wheels on the Bus." See if your child tries to do some of the actions.
- Say what you think your child is feeling (for example, sad, mad, frustrated, happy). Use your words, facial expressions, and v show what you think she is feeling. For example, say "You are frustrated because we can't go outside, but you can't hit. Let's an indoor game."
- Expect tantrums. They are normal at this age and are more likely if your child is tired or hungry. Tantrums should become sh happen less as he gets older. You can try a distraction, but it is ok to let him have the tantrum without doing anything. Give h time to calm down and move on.
- Teach your child "wanted behaviors." Show her what to do and use positive words or give her hugs and kisses when she doe example, if she pulls your pet's tail, teach her how to pet gently. Give her a hug when she does it.
- Limit screen time (TV, tablets, phones, etc.) to video calling with loved ones. Screen time is not recommended for children yo 2 years of age. Children learn by talking, playing, and interacting with others.
- Encourage your child to play with blocks. You can stack the blocks and she can knock them down.
- Let your child use a cup without a lid for drinking and practice eating with a spoon. Learning to eat and drink is messy but fu
- Give your child water, breast milk, or plain milk. You don't need to give your child juice, but if you do, give 4 ounces or less a 100% fruit juice. Do not give your child other sugary beverages, such as fruit drinks, soda, sports drinks, or flavored milks.
- Give your baby safe places to explore. Baby-proof your home. For example, move sharp or breakable things out of reach. Loc medicines, chemicals, and cleaning products. Save the Poison Help Line number, 800-222-1222, in all phones.
- Continue to talk, read, sing, and tell your child the names of things throughout the day. She will try to say and learn many ne which can help her read later on.
- Make a "book" with pictures of people and pets in your child's life. Name them as you look through the book together. Includ of your child.
- Sing or play children's songs and songs your family enjoys. Dance with your child.
- Read a new book after a favorite one to explore and try new books. Children like to do favorite things again and again. You c things they like to do to introduce new things.
- Play simple games, such as hide and seek. Let your child watch you hide behind a chair and then wait for her to come "find"
- Make up a simple "cleanup song" and sing it while you teach your child to help "clean up." Have him help put toys in a baske you things to put away.
- You can teach simple gestures and sign language (for example, pointing and waving) to help your child "talk" to you and sho she wants.
- "Pretend talk" to your child with a stuffed animal. See if your child tries to copy you or if he uses another stuffed animal to "t the one you are holding.
- Blow bubbles and let your child pop them. Say things as she pops them, such as "Pop, pop."

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CONTENT SOURCE
National Center on Birth Defects and Developmental Disabilities (NCBDDD)

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